

GRIT

AI Accountability Coach

Business Overview & Investment Case

Confidential Document — June 2026

WhatsApp-native · AI-powered · Zero app download required
Built on Claude AI · Deployed globally · Profitable from month 2

85% Gross Margin	£9.99 Primary Price Point	£279K Year 1 Profit (Conservative)	5:1 TV:CAC Ratio
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PAGE 1 — WHAT GRIT IS AND WHY IT EXISTS

The Problem

Millions of people set goals and never achieve them. Not because they lack desire — but because they lack consistent accountability. The self-improvement industry is worth over \$13 billion globally and growing, yet the single most common reason people fail their goals remains unchanged: no one is checking on them.

Existing solutions fall into three categories, all with fundamental flaws:

- **Personal trainers and life coaches** — Cost £40–£150 per session. Inaccessible to the majority. Professional accountability is a privilege reserved for those who can afford it.
- **Habit-tracking apps** — Require the user to self-report and return to the app voluntarily. No external nudge. 80% of users stop using them within 30 days.
- **Social accountability** — Telling a friend your goals works only when that friend remembers and follows up. In practice, it fades within weeks.

The Opportunity

WhatsApp has 2.7 billion active users globally. It is the most opened app on most people's phones. It requires no new download, no new login, no new habit. People already check it reflexively, multiple times a day.

Grit puts an AI accountability coach directly inside WhatsApp — making professional-grade accountability available to anyone, anywhere, for less than the cost of a single coffee per week.

What Grit Does

Step	What Happens
Step 1	User discovers Grit via a creator, ad, or word of mouth and taps a WhatsApp link
Step 2	10-question onboarding conversation via Claude AI — takes under 5 minutes
Step 3	Personalised 90-day plan generated and delivered as a branded PDF into their WhatsApp chat
Step 4	7-day free trial begins — morning motivation image + quote daily, 2x daily check-ins
Step 5	Streak tracking starts. Milestones celebrated. AI tone adapts based on their responses
Step 6	Stripe payment link sent at end of trial. Subscription activates. Coaching continues

PAGE 2 — WHY THIS WILL WORK

Five Reasons Grit Succeeds Where Others Have Failed

1. Zero Friction Onboarding

Every competitor requires app download, account creation, profile setup, and interface navigation before any value is delivered. Grit's onboarding is a WhatsApp conversation. The user is already in the app. Five minutes later they have a PDF plan — before spending a single penny. This makes Grit's cost of acquisition structurally lower than every app-based competitor.

2. WhatsApp's 98% Open Rate

Email open rates average 20–25%. Push notification click rates sit at 4–8%. WhatsApp message open rates exceed 98%. When Grit sends a morning message, users see it. When it sends a check-in, users respond. The channel does what no app notification can.

3. AI Makes It Genuinely Personal

Generic apps fail because users feel like a number. Grit uses Claude AI to remember every onboarding answer, every check-in reply, and every conversation. The AI adjusts tone, language, and suggestions based on what it knows about that specific person. This personalisation is the core product — not a feature.

4. Streak Psychology Drives Retention

Duolingo built a \$6 billion business largely on streak mechanics. The fear of losing a streak built over weeks is one of the most powerful retention tools in consumer technology. Grit embeds this from day one. Users do not cancel because cancelling means losing their streak, their history, and their plan.

5. Business Model Aligns With User Success

Grit only makes money when users stay subscribed. Users only stay when the product works. This alignment means the incentive is always to make the AI better and the outcomes more real. There is no dark pattern here — no addictive scroll feed, no engagement farming. The product succeeds when the user succeeds.

PAGE 3 — THE BUSINESS MODEL

Subscription Tiers

Tier	Monthly Price	Annual Equivalent	Target User
Core	£4.99/month	£59.88	Casual users, price-sensitive
Pro ★	£9.99/month	£119.88	Committed users — primary tier
Elite	£19.99/month	£239.88	Power users, high-income
Annual	£59.99/year	£5.00/month	Users wanting best value

★ Pro at £9.99/month is the anchor tier. Cheaper than one gym class, one PT session, or most streaming services.

Trial Model

Every new user receives 7 days completely free with no card required. During those 7 days they experience the full product. At the end of 7 days, Grit sends a payment link directly in WhatsApp. The conversion happens in the channel where the relationship has already been built.

Gross Margins Per Tier

Tier	Revenue	Cost Per User	Gross Profit	Margin
Core (£4.99)	£4.99	£1.25	£3.74	75%
Pro (£9.99)	£9.99	£1.50	£8.49	85%
Elite (£19.99)	£19.99	£1.75	£18.24	91%
Annual (£59.99)	£5.00 equiv	£1.25	£3.75	75%

SaaS businesses typically target 70–80% gross margin. Grit exceeds this at the Pro tier from day one.

Additional Revenue Streams (Phase 2)

Revenue Stream	Price	Notes
Streak Freeze Packs	£0.99 each / £3.99 for 5	High-engagement users pay to protect long streaks
90-Day Challenge Package	£49.99 one-time	Defined programme for users wanting a clear endpoint
Affiliate Commissions	Variable	Recommend relevant products (supplements, apps, courses)
Grit for Teams (B2B)	£7.99/employee/month	Corporate wellness — annual contracts, zero churn risk

PAGE 4 — COSTS AND FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

Cost Per User Per Month

Item	Cost	Notes
WhatsApp conversations	£0.90–£1.50	Meta Cloud API utility pricing
Claude AI (Haiku + Sonnet)	£0.05–£0.15	Haiku for check-ins, Sonnet for onboarding
Server and database	£0.01–£0.05	Railway, scales linearly with users
PDF storage and delivery	£0.01	Cloudflare R2, near zero cost
Total COGS per user	£1.00–£1.75	Blended average £1.25 — falls to £0.80 at scale

Fixed Monthly Costs at Launch

Item	Monthly Cost
Railway hosting and PostgreSQL	£5
Cloudflare R2 storage	£0 (free tier)
Domain and SSL	£1
Total fixed costs	£6/month

12-Month Financial Projections

Assumptions: Launch month 1, creator outreach month 2, 4–6 micro-influencer partnerships by month 3. Mix: 65% Pro, 25% Core, 10% Elite.

Month	New Signups	Paying Users	MRR	Costs	Profit
1	50	25	£225	£350	-£125
2	200	150	£1,350	£550	£800
3	500	500	£4,500	£1,200	£3,300
4	800	1,000	£9,000	£2,200	£6,800
6	1,200	2,500	£22,500	£4,800	£17,700
9	1,500	4,800	£43,200	£8,500	£34,700
12	2,500	8,200	£73,800	£13,500	£60,300

Year 1 Total Profit: ~£279,000 | Month 12 ARR: £885,600

Unit Economics

Metric	Value
Average Revenue Per User (ARPU)	£9.00/month
Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) via creators	£10–18
Average Customer Lifetime	11 months
Lifetime Value (LTV)	£85–£99
LTV:CAC Ratio	5:1–7:1 (target minimum 3:1)
Payback Period	6–8 weeks

PAGE 5 — MARKETING AND GO-TO-MARKET PLAN

Why Creator Marketing Is the Primary Channel

Traditional digital advertising requires significant testing budgets and targets users with intent signals that are difficult to define for a novel product. Creator marketing solves both problems: pre-built audiences who trust the recommendation, and a product that demonstrates itself — 'I let an AI text me every day for 30 days' is a video concept creators will want to make.

Three-Phase Creator Strategy

Phase	Timeline	Creator Size	Budget	Target Outcome
1 — Seeding	Months 1–3	10K–100K followers	£2,000–£5,000	15–20 creators, 20% affiliate
2 — Amplify	Months 3–6	100K–500K followers	£500–£2,000/video	3–5 dedicated videos
3 — Scale	Month 6+	All tiers + paid ads	Budget from revenue	Meta + TikTok retargeting

Affiliate Commission Structure

Creator Tier	Followers	Commission	Earnings per 300 Users
Standard Affiliate	Any	15% recurring	£450/month ongoing
Partner Creator	50K–500K	20% recurring	£600/month ongoing
Anchor Partner	1M+	25% + flat fee	£750/month + upfront

Built-In Viral Mechanics

- **The Screenshot Loop** — Every morning motivation image is watermarked with the Grit brand and short link. Users screenshot and share to Stories — free impressions at zero cost.
- **Milestone Shareable Graphics** — At 7, 14, 30, and 90-day streaks, Grit sends a branded shareable card. 'I just hit 30 days with Grit' creates authentic social proof no paid ad can replicate.
- **Referral Programme** — Users refer a friend via personal link — both get one free month. Social accountability is twice as powerful as solo accountability.
- **Challenge a Friend** — Invite one friend to a shared 30-day challenge. Two users acquired for the cost of one. Paired users have substantially lower churn.

What Would Not Work — and Why

App Store launch without WhatsApp

Minimum £50–150K development cost, 3–6 month build time, £25–50 per install acquisition cost versus £10–18 via creators. The no-download advantage is Grit's single most powerful competitive moat.

Targeting all demographics equally before data

Spending marketing budget broadly before retention data exists burns capital. Identify which goal category retains best and double down before expanding.

Building features before proving retention

Adding community feeds or video content before the core check-in loop is proven drives complexity without answering the fundamental question: do users stick?

PAGE 6 — RECOMMENDATIONS

Six Things That Would Meaningfully Accelerate This Business

1. Build a Founding Members Offer Before Launch

Reach out personally to 50–100 people in your network. Offer a Founding Member rate — £4.99/month locked for life — in exchange for honest feedback and a testimonial. This generates early revenue, creates invested beta testers, builds social proof before approaching creators, and creates a compelling story for partnerships.

2. Choose One Niche for Launch and Own It

Grit is built to serve all goal categories, but launching as everything to everyone is the fastest way to be nothing to anyone. Fitness is the strongest launch niche: visceral and visual progress, enormous creator ecosystem, binary check-in compliance, and the PDF plan is a high-perceived-value deliverable that justifies the trial immediately.

3. Publish Retention Data Publicly From Month 2

Most apps hide their retention numbers because they are poor. If Grit works — and the design gives it every reason to — publish monthly cohort data openly. '65% of Grit users still active at 60 days versus the 20% industry average' is a headline that journalists, newsletters, and potential investors find irresistible.

4. Create a Coach Persona With a Name and Personality

Consider developing a named AI coach character rather than a faceless app. Users form attachments to characters faster than to brands. Examples: Duolingo's Duo, Replika, Woebot. A coach with a defined backstory gives creators a character to introduce and gives users a relationship to invest in. Cost to implement: zero.

5. Approach One Corporate Employer Partnership in Month 4

Employee wellness is a £4.2 billion industry in the UK alone. A B2B 'Grit for Teams' offer at £7.99 per employee per month, invoiced annually, opens a revenue channel with zero churn risk and no per-user acquisition cost. Five companies at 50 employees each equals 250 guaranteed paying users and £23,970 guaranteed annual revenue from a single sales conversation.

6. Register the Business and IP Correctly Before Scale

Before approaching investors or large creators: register a limited company, publish terms of service and privacy policy (required for WhatsApp Business API approval and GDPR compliance), file a trademark application in key markets, and document data processing agreements with all sub-processors. None of these are glamorous. All become urgent at exactly the wrong moment if not handled in advance.

PAGE 7 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY AND INVESTMENT CASE

What it is

Grit is a WhatsApp-native AI accountability coaching service. Users define their goals, receive a personalised 90-day PDF plan, and get daily check-ins, morning motivation, and streak tracking — entirely through WhatsApp, with no app to download.

Why now

Three trends converge at this moment: AI language models have crossed the quality threshold where conversation is genuinely useful; WhatsApp Business API has matured and become accessible to independent developers; and post-pandemic culture has created a generational wave of people seeking self-improvement tools, with app fatigue making the no-download approach more valuable than ever.

Why it will work

Zero friction onboarding. A channel with 98% open rates. AI personalisation that makes every user feel individually coached. Streak psychology that makes cancellation feel costly. Pricing accessible to nearly anyone at £9.99/month. And a creator marketing channel that allows rapid, measurable, cost-controlled growth.

Why it is defensible

The moat is not the technology — any competitor can access Claude’s API. The moat is the data. Every user conversation, every check-in response, every streak pattern becomes proprietary data that improves the product over time. A competitor starting today starts without that data. The longer Grit runs, the harder it becomes to replicate.

The numbers

Launch cost under £500. Monthly running cost under £10 until first 50 paying users. Gross margin 85% at Pro tier. Conservative 12-month profit of £279,000. Moderate scenario £420,000. A single viral creator moment makes both figures look conservative.

What Is Needed to Succeed

Requirement	Status
Technical infrastructure (full backend)	■ Built and on GitHub
API accounts (Meta, Anthropic, Stripe, Railway, Cloudflare)	■ In progress — cost £6/month
Launch budget for creator partnerships	£2,000–£10,000
Retention-first discipline before scaling spend	Strategic decision
One niche focus at launch (recommended: fitness)	Strategic decision

**The question is not whether this business can work.
The question is how fast it can grow.**

Document prepared June 2026. All financial projections are estimates based on comparable market data and are not guarantees of future performance. Technical infrastructure built on the brettyryangit/Claude GitHub repository.